

Conductor — The Founder Plan

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- > **What this file is:** the long-term company plan — how Conductor grows from a product into a
- > multi-billion company. `Docs/ARP\_STRATEGY.md` owns the category and product scope (it always
- > wins on product questions). `Docs/plan/arp-roadmap.md` owns build order. **This file owns the**
- > company: **customers, revenue, team, funding, expansion, and the founder's own job.**
- > Written 2026-07-04. Review every quarter (\$14). Changes only by founder decision.

0. The honest math — what "multi-billion" actually requires

A plan aimed at a big number must start with the number. No magic, just arithmetic:

- Software companies are valued at roughly **10–15× annual recurring revenue (ARR)** when growing

fast. So a **\$2–3B company needs roughly \$200M ARR**.

- \$200M ARR at an average of **\$4,000/year per customer** (blended SMB + mid-market + platform

revenue) means roughly **50,000 paying companies** — or fewer companies paying more.

- Egypt has ~3.8M MSMEs, Saudi Arabia ~1.3M SMEs, the GCC together several hundred thousand more

that can pay real software prices. The market is big enough. **Egypt proves the product; the**

GCC pays for the company; the platform multiplies both.

Three consequences that shape everything below:

1. **Egypt alone cannot carry the valuation.** Egyptian SMB software prices are low. Egypt is the

proving ground and the talent base; **Saudi Arabia is the revenue engine** (Year 4–5, §7).

2. **Subscriptions alone cannot carry it either.** The plan adds revenue layers on schedule:

accountant channel → cloud tiers → AI usage → marketplace → adjacent products (§10).

3. **Ten years, six phases.** Each phase has an entry gate, a job, exit metrics, and a funding

event. You do not start a phase early. Skipping gates is how companies die looking busy.

1. The one structure to remember

Everything in this plan hangs on one ladder and three layers. If you can explain these two things,

you can explain the whole plan in one minute.

****The ladder**** (each rung must be solid before the next):

> Product → Proof → SaaS machine → Company → Platform & ecosystem → Category leader

****The three layers**** — every quarter, ask all three questions:

| Layer | Question | Owned by |

|---|---|---|

| Product | Do customers love using it? | ARP_STRATEGY + roadmap |

| Business | Do we acquire, keep, and grow customers profitably? | This file, §4-§10 |

| Company | Can the organization keep doing this without the founder in every room? | This file, §8-§13 |

A phase is done only when all three layers pass its gate.

2. The ten-year map (the whole plan on one screen)

| Phase | Years | Job | Headline exit metric | Funding event |

|---|---|---|---|---|

| ****1 — Product & proof**** | 2026-2027 | Finish the ARP core; 10 real companies run on it | Month-close runs live → public ARP claim | Bootstrap → YC / pre-seed |

| ****2 — Product-market fit**** | 2027-2028 | One ICP, 100 paying customers, they renew | ≥90% yearly retention, referrals arriving | Seed (~\$1-2M) |

| ****3 — SaaS machine**** | 2028-2029 | Repeatable selling; accountant channel; cloud default | \$1M ARR, growth without founder selling every deal | Series A (~\$5-10M) |

| ****4 — Company & KSA**** | 2029-2030 | Real org, leadership team, Saudi launch | \$5-8M ARR, KSA ≥30% of new revenue | Series B (~\$20-30M) |

| ****5 — Platform & ecosystem**** | 2030-2032 | API/SDK/marketplace; partners sell and build | \$25-40M ARR, ≥20% revenue non-subscription | Series C |

| ****6 — Category leader**** | 2032-2036 | Product family, GCC-wide + beyond, ARP = industry term | \$150-250M ARR | IPO / strategic options |

The rest of this file is these six phases in detail, then the systems that run underneath all of

them (brand, culture, hiring, trust, AI moat, funding, risks).

3. Phase 1 — Product & proof (2026 – mid-2027)

****You are here.**** The product phase is already planned in detail elsewhere — this section only

adds the company layer on top.

3.1 Product (already governed by the roadmap — summary only)

- Finish AI workspace sessions 01-15 (in flight).

- Phase A migration agent — **"spreadsheets to a running system in one afternoon."** This is not

just a feature: **it is the go-to-market weapon.** ERP dies at implementation; ours takes an

afternoon. Customer acquisition cost drops with every hour this saves.

- Phase B autonomous month-close — the flagship. Its live run at a real customer **opens the**

claims gate****** and is the launch moment of the company, not just the feature.

3.2 Business — the first 10 customers

- **Pick ONE ICP now and write it down:** recommended — **trading & distribution SMBs in Egypt**

(10-100 employees) that already work with an external accountant. **Why:** they have inventory +

invoices + VAT pain (our exact money loop), they exist in huge numbers, and their accountant is

a repeatable channel (roadmap Phase F was designed for exactly this).

- Acquire 10 pilot companies personally. Free or near-free is fine — **the payment is data,**

weekly feedback calls, and permission to tell their story.******

- Onboard every one through the migration agent yourself. Watch every stumble. Each stumble is a

product task the next week.

- Keep a simple customer log (one doc per customer): what they use daily, what they ignore, what

they asked for, when they last opened the app.

3.3 Company

- Team = founder (+ AI sessions). That is correct for this phase. Do not hire yet.

- Register the company properly (Egypt entity now; hold a note to add a holding structure —

commonly ADGM/Delaware — when the first outside money arrives, on lawyer's advice, §12).

- Start two habits that scale later: **write every decision down** (DECISIONS.md already does

this — extend the habit to business decisions), and **a weekly metrics note** even when the

metrics are tiny. The habit is the asset.

3.4 Funding

- Bootstrap through the build. When Phase B demo is live, **apply to YC** (the roadmap already names it) with the working ARP demo. YC or a comparable pre-seed (~\$500K) buys Phase 2.

3.5 Exit gate — do not enter Phase 2 until:

- [] Month-close ran live at a real customer, audit trail complete (public ARP claim unlocked).
- [] 10 companies operate on Conductor; ≥ 7 open it every working day.
- [] Migration of a real messy company takes $\leq$ one afternoon, zero consultant hours.
- [] Written ICP one-pager exists and the 10 pilots match it.

4. Phase 2 — Product-market fit (mid-2027 – 2028)

Job: prove that one type of company will pay, stay, and refer — repeatedly.

4.1 Business

- Convert pilots to paid. Simple pricing, published openly: suggested start — **per-company monthly tiers** (e.g., Basic / Standard / Growth by user count and modules),
priced in EGP for Egypt from day one. Annual pays 10 months. No custom deals yet.
- Grow 10 → 50 → 100 paying customers. Channels, in order of expected efficiency:
 1. **Referrals from the 10 pilots** (ask explicitly; make a one-line referral promise).
 2. **External accountants** who serve the pilots (seed the Phase-F channel early — even informally: an accountant who recommends Conductor gets priority support and a discount code).
 3. **Arabic content**: YouTube + LinkedIn showing the real product doing real work — the month-close closing itself, the migration agent eating a real spreadsheet. Demo-driven, never hype (claims discipline, STRATEGY §6.6).
- Talk to every customer personally. 100 customers is still founder-scale. Every churn gets a written post-mortem sentence.

4.2 The five numbers of this phase (measure weekly, no more than these)

| Metric | Target by end of phase |

|---|---|

- | Paying customers | 100 |
- | Logo retention (yearly) | $\geq 90\%$ |
- | Weekly active companies / paying | $\geq 80\%$ |
- | Time-to-value (signup → first real month closed) | ≤ 30 days |
- | Referral share of new customers | $\geq 25\%$ |

4.3 Product

- Scope discipline holds absolutely (STRATEGY §5): no HR, no manufacturing, no projects. This

phase adds **depth in the money loop** driven by pilot feedback, plus roadmap Phases C-D

(daily brief, anomaly watch, bank photo recon) — retention features, all of them.

4.4 Company — first hires (only after ~50 paying)

1. **Support/success engineer** (Arabic-native, technical) — takes onboarding and support off the

founder. Hire #1 because founder time is the bottleneck asset.

2. **Full-stack engineer** — takes the well-specified build work.

3. **Part-time finance/ops** — invoicing, payroll, government paperwork.

- Write the first version of the culture one-pager **before** hire #1 (§9) — the first three

hires copy the founder; make what they copy explicit.

4.5 Exit gate — do not enter Phase 3 until:

- [] 100 paying, $\geq 90\%$ retention, referrals $\geq 25\%$ of new logos.
- [] Pricing page public; average revenue per account known and stable.
- [] Founder no longer does routine support.
- [] Seed raised (~\$1-2M) on the PMF numbers — or revenue covers the Phase-3 plan without it.

5. Phase 3 — The SaaS machine (2028 – 2029)

Job: make growth repeatable — revenue that arrives on a schedule, from a process, not from the

founder's personal effort.

5.1 The four business functions (small, but real)

- **Sales:** one process, written: inbound demo → migration-agent trial on the customer's own

data → close. The trial IS the demo — competitors show slides; we show **their** company already

running. Hire 1-2 Arabic-native account executives; founder still closes big/strategic deals.

- **Marketing:** Arabic-first content engine — YouTube (product truth, real flows), LinkedIn,

SEO on the money keywords («تأسيس جمارك», «نورتك للإدارة», ERP عربي...), customer

stories with real numbers. One content person + freelancers.

- **Customer success:** onboarding (mostly the migration agent + one human call), a real

knowledge base in Arabic and English, in-app help. Renewal owned by a named person, not by hope.

- **Finance:** subscription billing automated (this is also roadmap Phase F cloud work),

MRR/churn/cohort dashboard, 18-month cash model updated monthly.

5.2 Distribution — the accountant channel goes formal (roadmap Phase F, part 1)

- Ship the **accountant portal** (one login, many client companies). Launch a named partner

program: an accountant who brings clients gets recurring revenue share + certification +

a directory listing. Target: **50 active accountant-partners by end of phase.** Every accountant is a salesperson we do not employ.

5.3 Platform groundwork — cloud default (roadmap Phase F, part 2)

- Cloud multi-tenant becomes the default offering; self-hosted becomes the premium/enterprise

option. This is the scalability hinge of the whole company: after it, serving customer #1,000

costs marginally nothing.

5.4 The numbers

| Metric | Target by end of phase |

|---|---|

| ARR | \$1M (mix of Egypt volume + first GCC logos at GCC prices) |

| Paying customers | 400-600 |

| Net revenue retention | $\geq 100\%$ (expansion covers churn) |

| CAC payback | ≤ 12 months |

| Team | 8-12 people |

5.5 Exit gate

- [] Three consecutive quarters where new-MRR arrived from the process (channel + inbound),

not from founder heroics.

- [] Accountant channel producing $\geq 20\%$ of new customers.
- [] Cloud default live; gross margin $\geq 75\%$.
- [] Series A raised ($\sim \$5\text{--}10\text{M}$) — the explicit use of funds is \$6: the company and Saudi Arabia.

6. Phase 4 — The company & Saudi Arabia (2029 – 2030)

****Job:** build the organization, and open the market that pays. The founder's product is now the company itself.**

6.1 Saudi Arabia — the revenue engine

- ****Why KSA:**** SME software budgets 5–10× Egyptian ones, same language, Vision-2030 digitization

push, and ****ZATCA e-invoicing is mandatory**** — every SME must buy compliant software. Our

Arabic-first, compliance-serious DNA is a home game there, not localization.

- Entry checklist (each item is a project): ZATCA e-invoicing certification · Saudi VAT rules ·

data residency (KSA cloud region) · SAR pricing & local payments · a Riyadh presence (country

lead + 2–3 sales/success hires; consider the Saudi accelerator/partner route) · 2–3

implementation partners signed before launch, not after.

- Same ICP, same playbook (migration-agent trial), Saudi prices. Target: ****KSA $\geq 30\%$ of new**

revenue within 18 months of launch.**

- UAE follows KSA by $\sim$ a year with the same checklist (lighter: no ZATCA, easier entity setup).

6.2 The organization (30–60 people by end of phase)

- Founder stops being the manager of everyone. Hire/promote a leadership layer:

****Head of Engineering · Head of Product/Design · Head of Revenue (sales+marketing)**

.

Head of Customer Success · Head of Finance & Ops · KSA Country Lead.**

- Each function gets the same treatment code got: written standards, a hiring scorecard, an

onboarding doc, a metrics review. ("Operate the company with the product's quality bar.")

- Hiring system (this phase, not later): scorecards per role → structured interviews (work

sample, not puzzles) → written offer bands → career ladder v1 → twice-yearly reviews.

****Egypt is the talent arbitrage:**** world-class engineering cost base serving GCC revenue.

6.3 The numbers

| Metric | Target by end of phase |

| ---|---|

| ARR | \$5-8M |

| KSA share of new MRR | $\geq 30\%$ |

| Team | 30-60 |

| Founder's calendar | $\geq 50\%$ on hiring, strategy, capital — not tickets |

6.4 Exit gate

- [] Leadership team runs weekly business without the founder in every meeting.
- [] KSA unit economics proven (CAC payback ≤ 12 months at Saudi prices).
- [] Culture doc + hiring system in active use (they decide real hires and promotions).
- [] Series B raised ($\sim \$20-30M$) for platform + GCC expansion.

7. Phase 5 — Platform & ecosystem (2030 - 2032)

****Job:** let other people build on Conductor and sell Conductor. An ecosystem grows while you

sleep; a product only grows while you work.**

7.1 Platform (the product becomes a place)

- ****Public API + webhooks + SDK**** — the same contracts (`erp/*/contracts/``) the AI already uses,

exposed properly. The architecture was built for this; now it becomes a product.

- ****AI Skills / agent marketplace:**** third parties write vertical agents (pharmacy compliance,

food-distribution routing, construction billing) that run inside Conductor's permission and

audit model — the ARP mechanics (actor-scoped, human-in-the-loop) become ****the platform's**

safety guarantee**, the thing competitors can't bolt on.

- ****Marketplace with revenue share**** (industry standard $\sim 80/20$). Integrations first (banks,

payment gateways, shipping, POS hardware, government portals), vertical agents second.

7.2 Ecosystem (the company grows a shell of allies)

- ****Partner program v2, tiered:**** implementation partners · accounting firms (the Phase-3 channel,

now hundreds) · resellers per country · technology partners.

- **Certification academy:** paid certification for accountants and consultants — "Conductor

Certified" becomes a line on CVs in Cairo and Riyadh. Universities: free education licenses —

students who learn on Conductor hire Conductor later.

- **Annual conference + developer events** — the category's stage. By now ARP is public; the

conference is where "ARP" is defined for the industry, by us, with customers on stage.

7.3 Geography

- Complete the GCC: UAE consolidated, Kuwait/Qatar/Oman/Bahrain via resellers (no of fices).

Jordan + North Africa via partners. Each entry = the \$6.1 checklist, sized to the market.

7.4 The numbers

| Metric | Target by end of phase |

|---|---|

| ARR | \$25-40M |

| Non-subscription revenue (marketplace, services, certification, AI usage) | $\geq 20\%$ |

| Active partners | 300+ |

| Third-party apps/agents in marketplace | 50+ |

| Team | 120-200 |

7.5 Exit gate

- [] A third party earns real money on the platform (the ecosystem test).

- [] A country entered with partners only turned profitable.

- [] Net revenue retention $\geq 115\%$ (platform expansion revenue).

8. Phase 6 — Category leader (2032 – 2036)

Job: make "ARP" an industry term with Conductor as its reference, expand the product family,

and build a company that outlives its founder's daily attention.

- **Product family** — each new product reuses the platform (identity, permissions, AI runtime,

design system) and reinforces the core. Priority order, each gated on customer evidence, not

ambition: **POS** (retail ICP already asks) → **HR & Payroll** (the \$5-freeze lifts only now,

by explicit decision — the money loop is unbeatable, the customer base demands it)
→

BI/analytics → **Procurement network** (SMBs buying from each other inside Conductor —

the network-effect product) → **AI Studio** (customers compose their own agents).

- **Geography:** MENA leadership consolidated; English-market entry (South Africa / UK / SEA)

only if GCC growth alone can't carry the plan — a decision, not a default.

- **Data & AI advantage compounds (§11):** by now millions of documents/month flow through

migration, month-close, and anomaly agents. Benchmarks ("companies like yours collect in 34

days; you take 51"), industry-tuned agents, forecasting — with consent, anonymized, compliant.

This moat gets deeper every month and cannot be copied by a competitor starting to day.

- **Enduring-company systems:** succession plans per key role · leadership development ·

long-term R&D allocation (~10% outside the roadmap) · real governance (board, audit,

risk) · institutional memory (the DECISIONS habit, grown up).

- **The numbers:** ARR \$150–250M · NRR ≥ 120% · team 400–700 · **IPO-ready or strategically**

optional — the multi-billion outcome is now an output of the machine, not a hope.

The underneath — systems that run through every phase

9. Brand & culture (start now, never stop)

- **Brand is already a real asset** — the triad (Brief/Directive/Identity), the Arabic lexicon,

monochrome chrome, "Linear's craft, Telegram's calm". Most startups buy this in Year 4 with an

agency; Conductor has it at Year 0. **Protect it like code** (the gates already do). As surfaces

multiply (site, decks, conference, merch, mobile), the Identity System governs all of them.

- **Culture = the values order, made operational.** Trust > Simplicity > Local fit > Consistency >

Quality > Speed is already the tie-breaker (STRATEGY §6.11). Before hire #1, write the culture

one-pager: the values order · "would Linear ship this?" · blame-free errors (in the product AND

the team) · write decisions down · demo over claim · one way to do each thing. Use it in every

interview; review against it; promote by it. Culture is what the founder repeats until others

repeat it.

10. Revenue layers (added on schedule, never all at once)

| Layer | Arrives | Note |

|---|---|---|

| SaaS subscriptions | Phase 2 | The spine, always $\geq 60\%$ |

| Accountant/partner channel share | Phase 3 | Distribution we don't salary |

| Cloud tiers (default) + premium self-hosted | Phase 3 | Self-hosted becomes the enterprise upsell |

| AI usage credits (heavy agent use beyond plan) | Phase 4 | Meter exists in the agent loop already |

| KSA/GCC pricing | Phase 4 | Same product, 5–10× price point |

| Certification & academy | Phase 5 | Also a hiring + ecosystem tool |

| Marketplace revenue share | Phase 5 | ~20% of third-party sales |

| Premium support / enterprise contracts | Phase 5 | SLA-backed |

| Adjacent products (POS, HR...) | Phase 6 | Each on the platform, each cross-sold |

11. The data & AI moat (the compounding asset)

Every phase feeds it: migration agent sees every messy company (Phase A) → month-close sees every

book (Phase B) → anomaly watch learns every fraud pattern (Phase C) → bank vision reads every

statement format (Phase D) → WhatsApp hears every question in Egyptian Arabic (Phase E).

****Rules that make it an asset instead of a liability:**** consent explicit and granular · anonymized

aggregates only · the six ARP mechanics never weaken (actor-scoped, auditable, human-in-the-loop)

· a public AI-responsibility page from Phase 3. Trust is value #1; the moat is only a moat if

customers brag about giving us the data.

12. Trust & compliance ladder (buyers get bigger; proof must too)

| Phase | Minimum bar |

|---|---|

| 1-2 | Daily backups + restore drills · encryption at rest/in transit · RBAC + audit (built) · uptime honesty |

| 3 | 99.9% SLA · status page · pen test · Egyptian e-invoice (ETA) integration · public security page |

| 4 | ZATCA certification · KSA data residency · SOC 2 Type I → II · incident-response runbook |

| 5-6 | ISO 27001 · per-country data residency · transparent incident history · annual third-party audits |

Legal/structure: Egypt entity now → holding structure (ADGM or Delaware, on counsel's advice) at

first institutional money → KSA entity at Phase 4 → per-market entities only when revenue justifies.

13. The founder's own ladder (plan your obsolescence at each level)

| Team size | Founder's actual job | Must let go of |

|---|---|---|

| 1-10 (Ph. 1-2) | Builder: product + first customers personally | Nothing yet — depth is the job |

| 10-30 (Ph. 3) | Manager: hire, write the playbooks, run the metrics week | Routine support, routine code |

| 30-100 (Ph. 4) | Leader: hire leaders, culture, KSA, capital | Managing individuals directly |

| 100-300 (Ph. 5) | Executive: strategy, allocation, key partners, category story | Being in most decisions |

| 300+ (Ph. 6) | CEO/vision: the category, the family of products, the next decade | Everything but direction, people, capital |

One habit survives every level: ****write it down**** (decisions, culture, playbooks). The company's

memory must live in systems, not in the founder — that is the literal definition of an enduring

company, and it is the same discipline the repo already practices.

14. Risks and their counters (name them now, review quarterly)

| Risk | Counter |

|---|---|

| Egypt macro/currency | GCC revenue from Phase 4 = hard-currency hedge; costs stay in EGP |

| Incumbent (Odoo/local) copies "AI features" | They can bolt on chat; they can't retrofit actor-scoped, auditable agentic architecture — keep the six mechanics inviolable and

keep shipping the demos |

| Founder burnout / bus factor | The \$13 ladder + write-everything-down + leadership layer at Phase 4 |

| AI cost/quality shifts | Model-agnostic agent layer; usage-based pricing passes cost through |

| Compliance surprise (e-invoicing rule changes) | Compliance is a product feature with an owner, not a chore — budget for it every phase |

| Scope creep (the eternal one) | STRATEGY §5 refuse-list applies to the COMPANY too: no new market, product, or program without a written decision and a gate passed |

| Fundraising winter | Every phase's plan is survivable at 60% of the target raise; default-alive after Phase 3 is the standing goal |

15. What we refuse (the company-level refuse list)

The product has one (STRATEGY §5). The company gets one too:

1. **No phase-skipping.** No Series A before repeatable sales, no KSA before PMF, no marketplace before partners exist.
2. **No revenue that fights the product** — no consulting business that turns us into an agency, no custom forks, no white-labeling that hides the brand.
3. **No feature-grid selling, no hype claims** — demos or silence, at every company size.
4. **No hiring ahead of proof.** Headcount follows revenue evidence, never precedes it.
5. **No market entry without the checklist** (§6.1) and a named owner.

16. Review cadence — how this file stays alive

- **Weekly (founder, 30 min):** the current phase's metric table — numbers only.
- **Quarterly:** full read of this file. Update targets from reality. Gates are moved only by a written, dated decision at the bottom of this file.
- **Yearly:** re-derive \$0's math from actual ARR and market data. If the ladder needs reshaping, reshape it here first — never by drift.

17. Change log

- **2026-07-04 — Created.** Six phases 2026→2036, gates, funding ladder, KSA thesis, revenue layers, refuse list. Companion to `Docs/ARP\_STRATEGY.md` (product canon) and `Docs/plan/arp-roadmap.md` (build order).